



KIAN RAVAEI

**BEFORE
MEMORY**

for saxophone quartet

(score)

ÆI edition

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MEMORY**

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(2026)

(score)

I. Rest.....	1
II. Play	4

Commissioned by
Colere Quartet (Lead Commissioner)

and

Ancia Quartet
Aruna Quartet
Basement Saxophone Quartet
The Big Su
Blitz Quartet
Cerus Quartet
Crossroads Quartet
h2 Quartet
Hierax Quartet
Kodachrome
Lighthouse Quartet
Medusa Saxophone Quartet
Zed Quartet

PROGRAM NOTE

Writing for saxophones, equally capable of serene quietude and boisterous energy, led me to imagine our first years of existence—the only time in our lives we cannot remember—when there was not a care in the world: only rest and play.

—Kian Ravaei

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duration ca. 8'

(Transposed)

BEFORE MEMORY

I. Rest

Kian Ravaei
(2026)

Soothing, precious $\text{♩} = 33$

non vib.

pp delicate

non vib.

pp delicate

non vib.

pp delicate

non vib.

pp delicate

Soprano Saxophone

Alto Saxophone

Tenor Saxophone

Baritone Saxophone

5

rit. a tempo rit. a tempo

S.

A.

T.

B.

p

poco vib. ad lib.

p

poco vib. ad lib.

p

10

poco vib. ad lib.

S.

A.

T.

B.

non vib.

rit. a tempo rit. Pushing slightly $\text{♩} = 38$

non vib.

(*p* sempre)

poco vib. ad lib.

ppp airy non vib.

ppp airy

ppp airy

ppp airy

poco rit.

pp

mp

p

pp

p

mf

p

pp

p

pp

mp

p

pp

p

mf

p

Tempo I, like resonant glass $\text{♩} = 33$

soft slap into sustain

pp decay after each slap

soft slap into sustain

pp decay after each slap

soft slap into sustain

pp decay after each slap

soft slap into sustain

pp decay after each slap

31

S. *rit.* *a tempo* *rit.* *a tempo* *poco vib. ad lib.*

A. *mp* *pp* *3* *pp* *poco vib. ad lib.*

T. *mp* *pp* *3* *pp* *poco vib. ad lib.*

B. *mp* *pp* *pp gentle* *(* = add 4 5 6 C Bb keys, quasi bisbigliando)*

37

S. *rit.* *mp* *pp* *mf* *pp*

A. *mp* *pp* *mf* *pp*

T. *pp gentle* *(* = add low Bb key, quasi bisbigliando)*

B. *pp gentle* *pp* *mf* *pp*

42 **Freely**

S. *p espr.* *pp* *ppp*

A. *p* *pp* *ppp*

T. *p* *pp* *ppp*

B. *p* *pp* *ppp*

II. Play

Cheeky, brisk ♩ = 176

Soprano Saxophone

Alto Saxophone

Tenor Saxophone

Baritone Saxophone

f 5 *ff*

(grace notes before the beat)

ff

(grace notes before the beat)

ff

S.

A.

T.

B.

sff

p staccatiss.

sff

p staccatiss.

sff

f

sff

S.

A.

T.

B.

open slap

ff explosive

16

S.

A.

T.

B.

(open slap)

21

S.

A.

T.

B.

f *mf* *mp*

f *mf* *mp*

mf *mp*

ord.

f *mf* *mp*

27

S.

A.

T.

B.

p *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff*

p *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff* *pp*

p *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff* *pp*

p *pp* *ff* *pp*

(grace notes before the beat)

(grace notes before the beat)

33

S.

A.

T.

B.

pp *ff* *pp* *ff* *pp*

ff *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff* *pp*

ff *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff* *pp*

ff *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff* *pp*

38

S.

A.

T.

B.

ff *ff*

42

S.

A.

T.

B.

p *p* *p* *f* *f* *f*

47

S.

A.

T.

B.

ff

ff

f

ff

5

5

9

51

S.

A.

T.

B.

sff

sff

f

sff

sff

p staccatiss.

57

S.

A.

T.

B.

ff obnoxious

ff obnoxious

growl

growl

63

growl

S. *ff*

A.

T. *ff*

B.

68

growl

S. *ff*

A.

T. *ff*

B.

73

(growl)

ord.

scoop

S. *f* *mp* *pp* *ff*^{jazzy}

A. *mp* *pp* *ff*^{jazzy}

T. (growl) *f* *mp* *pp* *ff*^{jazzy}

B. *f*_{sub.} *mp* *pp* *ff*^{jazzy}

79

S. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

A. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

T. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

B. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

(4+3) (3+4)

84

S. ff pp ff pp ff pp ff

A. ff pp ff pp ff pp ff

T. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

B. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

(4+3) (3+4)

89

S. ff pp ff pp ff pp ff

A. ff pp ff pp ff pp ff

T. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

B. pp ff pp ff pp ff pp

93

S.

A.

T.

B.

sff

f

sff

9

Measures 93-97. Soprano (S.) and Alto (A.) have melodic lines with slurs. Tenor (T.) has a complex melodic line with a 9-measure slur. Bass (B.) has a simple melodic line. Dynamics include *sff* and *f*.

98

S.

A.

T.

B.

p

ff

p

ff

ff

Measures 98-103. Soprano (S.) has a melodic line. Alto (A.) and Tenor (T.) have melodic lines with slurs. Bass (B.) has a simple melodic line. Dynamics include *p* and *ff*.

104

S.

A.

T.

B.

ff

ff

(ff)

Measures 104-108. Soprano (S.) has a melodic line. Alto (A.) and Tenor (T.) have melodic lines with slurs. Bass (B.) has a simple melodic line. Dynamics include *ff* and *(ff)*.

110

S.

A.

T.

B.

p

p

115

S.

A.

T.

B.

ff

ff

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

122

S.

A.

T.

B.

pp

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

pp

ff

128

S. *pp* *ff*

A. *pp* *ff*

T. *pp* *ff*

B. *pp* *ff*

133

(quarter tone descent)

S. *p sub. cresc.*

A. *p sub. cresc.*

(quarter tone ascent)

T. *p sub. cresc.*

(quarter tone ascent)

B. *p sub. cresc.*

139

S. *ff* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf*

A. *ff* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf*

T. *ff* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf*

B. *ff*

145

S. *f* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *f* *mf* *pp*

A. *f* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *f* *mf* *pp*

T. *f* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *f* *mf* *pp*

B. *f* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *f* *mf* *pp*

152

S. *mf* *pp* *cresc.*

A. *mf* *pp* *cresc.*

T. *mf* *pp* *cresc.*

B. *mf* *pp* *cresc.*

158

S. *f* *ff* *dim. al niente* *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff*

A. *f* *ff* *dim. al niente* *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff*

T. *f* *ff* *dim. al niente* *pp* *ff* *pp* *ff*

B. *f* *pp* *ff*

long voiced fall,
as far as possible

long voiced fall,
as far as possible

long voiced fall,
as far as possible

[illegible]

(ossia: 8vb through bar 174)

170

S.

ff ³

tr

A.

ff

³

tr

T.

³

B.

³

176

S.

A.

T.

B.

ff

ff

ff

ff

184

S. *pp* *trm* *f*

A. *pp* *trm* *f*

T. *pp* *trm* *f*

B. *pp* *trm* *f*

Measures 184-187. Soprano and Alto parts feature trills and dynamic markings (*pp*, *f*). Tenor and Bass parts have dynamic markings (*f*). The key signature has one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 3/4.

191

S.

A.

T.

B.

Measures 191-194. Soprano and Alto parts continue with melodic lines. Tenor and Bass parts have dynamic markings (>). The key signature has one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 3/4.

197

S.

A.

T.

B.

Measures 197-200. Soprano and Alto parts continue with melodic lines. Tenor and Bass parts have dynamic markings (>). The key signature has one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 3/4.

205

S. *pp* *ff* *pp*

A. *pp* *ff* *pp*

T. *pp* *ff* *pp*

B. *pp* *ff* *pp*

211

S. *ff* *f*

A. *ff* *f*

T. *ff* *f*

B. *ff* *f*

217

S.

A. *p staccatiss.*

T.

B. *open slap*
ff explosive

223 growl

S. *ff* obnoxious

A. *ff* (ord.)

T. *ff* obnoxious (ord.)

B. *ff*

rit. poco a poco

229

S. *p* cresc.....

A. *p sub.* (quarter tone descent) cresc.....

T. *p sub.* (quarter tone ascent) cresc.....

B. *p sub.* (quarter tone ascent) cresc.....

a tempo

235

S. *f* 5 *fff* 9

A. *f* 5 *fff* 9

T. *f* *fff*

B. *f* *fff*

241

S.

A.

T.

B.

rit.

9

246

a tempo

S.

A.

T.

B.

pp

pp

pp sub.

pp

pp

pp sub.

250

S.

A.

T.

B.

fff

fff

fff

fff

3

3

3

3

fff

fff

fff

fff

